

# Acknowledgments

I (RH) must begin with a note of gratitude to my wife, Rieky Keeris, who provided me with a happy environment and encouragement while writing this book.

I (PP) owe a debt of gratitude to my parents, my brother Hari, and my sister-in-law Devaki for all their love and encouragement. They put up with my long periods of absence from family events as I worked on this book. I must also thank my brother for being my best friend and a constant source of support all my life.

We are happy to express our appreciation to Debby Hix for a career-long span of collegial interaction. We are also grateful for the long-term professional associations and friendships at Virginia Tech with Roger Ehrich, Bob and Bev Williges, Manuel A. Pérez-Quinones, Ed Fox, John Kelso, Sean Arthur, Mary Beth Rosson, and Joe Gabbard.

We are indebted to Brad Myers of Carnegie Mellon University for his support of this book from the start and for trying out some of the material in his HCI course.

Special thanks to Akshay Sharma in the Virginia Tech Department of Industrial Design for giving us access to photograph the ideation studio and working environment there, including students at work and the sketches and prototypes they produced. Finally, our thanks for the many photographs and sketches provided by Akshay to include as figures in design chapters.

We acknowledge with pleasure the positive influence of Jim Foley, Dennis Wixon, and Ben Shneiderman, with whom our friendship goes back decades and transcends professional relationships.

I'll (RH) always be grateful for the warm welcome I received from Phil Gray and the people in the Department of Computing Science at the University of Glasgow, who hosted my wonderful sabbatical in 1989. Special thanks to Steve Draper, Department of Psychology, University of Glasgow, for his companionship and for providing a comfortable and congenial place for me to live while there.

Many thanks to Kim Gausepohl, who helped as a sounding board for ideas about integrating UX into real-world agile software environments. And we extend our appreciation to our long-time friend Mathew Mathai and others

in the Network Infrastructure and Services group in the IT organization at Virginia Tech. Mathew was instrumental in giving us access to a real-world agile development environment and the invaluable learning experience that went with it.

Special thanks to Ame Wongsu for the many insightful conversations over the years about the nature of design, information architecture, and UX practice, and for providing us with the wireframes for the camping application example. We also thank Christina Janczak for providing us with the mood boards and other visual designs for this example, as well as the design for the book cover.

Finally, we are grateful for all the support from Steve Merken, Josh Mearns, Prasanna Kalyanaraman, Mohan Raj Rajendran, and Mason Malloy at Morgan Kaufman. We are especially grateful for the diligence and professionalism of the reviewers, especially Profs. Panagiotis Apostolellis and Kristian Secor, the anonymous reviewers, and our editors for their valuable suggestions that have helped make the book much better. It has been a pleasure to work with this organization.